Chris Townsend: “We based Extremis on natural phenomena—the way chemicals react with other chemicals, the way plants grow, the way limbs regrow on lizards, how fungus grows and decays. We did research based on time-lapse photography, and looked at how light and energy move through different substances. We took reference from aurora borealis, from time-lapse of lights going across a desert, from putting a bright light source behind a hand and having that sort of internal glow, from X-ray photography—from all kinds of different things. And then we started developing what we wanted it to look like and what we didn’t want it to look like.”

Rodney Fuentebella concept art.